

AFL-CIO LEGISLATIVE SCORECARD

2018

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard>
Retrieved 8 August 2026
Records 15 House, 5 Senate

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

1. Tribal Labor Sovereignty Act

S. 140 · January 10, 2018
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 239 NAYs 173
This bill amends the White Mountain Apache Tribe Water Rights Quantification Act of 2010 and denies coverage afforded by the National Labor Relations Act (NLRA) to a large number of workers employed by tribal-owned and -operated enterprises located on Indian land. Among them are more than 600,000 tribal casino workers, the vast majority of whom are not Native Americans. In recent years, the number and type of enterprises affected has grown well beyond the gaming industry, and would now include mining operations, power plants, smoke shops, saw mills, construction companies, ski resorts, high-tech firms, hotels and spas. Many of these are commercial businesses that compete with non-Indian enterprises. The Tribal Labor Sovereignty Act passed the House on January 10, 2018.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/tribal-labor-sovereignty-act>

2. Financial Stability Oversight Council Improvement Act

H.R. 4061 · April 11, 2018
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 297 NAYs 121
This misnamed bill adds a number of unnecessary procedural obstacles to the already cumbersome and time-consuming process the Financial Stability Oversight Council (FSOC) uses to designate large, non-bank financial entities for increased oversight. The 2008 financial crisis made it obvious that proper consolidated oversight of large non-banks is critical to financial stability. Non-bank financial institutions such as AIG were central contributors to the 2008 crisis and the ensuing economic collapse. The FSOC's ability to designate non-bank financial companies for enhanced prudential supervision is a crucial line of defense against future systemic risks from non-banks. If enacted this bill has the potential to unravel the regulatory system aimed at preventing the need for future bailouts of "too-big-to-fail" financial institutions. The bill passed on April 11, 2018, and referred to the Senate Banking Committee.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/financial-stability-oversight-council-improvement-act>

3. Stress Test Improvement Act

H.R. 4293 · April 11, 2018
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 245 NAYs 174
The misnamed bill would significantly weaken stress testing by preventing regulators from assessing the capacity of big banks to perform adequate data analysis or risk management as part of the stress testing process. Specifically, the bill would ban the Federal Reserve from assessing the capacity of big banks to perform crucial data management and risk assessment tasks as part of the stress testing process. H.R. 4293 would undermine the effectiveness of stress testing for the largest and most complex banks and cut the frequency of stress tests in half. If enacted this bill has the potential to unravel the regulatory system aimed at preventing the need for future bailouts of "too-big-to-fail" financial institutions. The bill passed the House on April 11, 2018, and referred to the Senate Banking Committee.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/stress-test-improvement-act>

4. Proposing a Balanced Budget Amendment to the U.S. Constitution

H.J. Res. 2 · April 12, 2018
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 233 NAYs 184
This resolution, introduced by Rep. Bob Goodlatte (R-Va.), would prohibit federal outlays from exceeding receipts, require a three-fifths vote to increase the public debt limit, and direct the President to submit a balanced budget annually to Congress. Proposing a balanced budget amendment after enacting a tax cut that will increase the debt by almost \$2 trillion dollars and an omnibus appropriation bill that will further add to our nation's debt proves that in Washington, D.C. hypocrisy knows no bounds. The truth is that the proponents of H.J. Res. 2 are not motivated by deficit concerns; rather, they are using a deficit they created to force severe budget cuts in programs that will harm the most vulnerable among us, especially seniors, children, veterans and people with disabilities, as

well as slash funding for public health and safety, education and medical research. The motion to suspend the rules and pass the resolution failed to receive a two-thirds majority on April 12, 2018.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/proposing-balanced-budget-amendment-us-constitution>

5. Volcker Rule Regulatory Harmonization Act

H.R. 4790 · April 13, 2018

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 300 NAYs 104

This bill would undermine the implementation of the Volcker Rule by giving sole rulemaking authority to the Federal Reserve and allowing banks with less than \$10 billion in assets to engage in proprietary trading with publicly insured deposits. A core component of the Volcker Rule is to prevent banks from using deposited money to finance speculative trading. Yet, the bill would cut the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (FDIC), the custodian and institutional protector of the deposit insurance fund, entirely out of the implementation of the Volcker Rule. H.R. 4790 would eliminate the FDIC's role in writing and interpreting the rule and weaken the interpretation of the rule and its enforcement. If enacted this bill has the potential to unravel the regulatory system aimed at preventing the need for future bailouts of "too-big-to-fail" financial institutions. The bill passed the House on April 11, 2018, and referred to the Senate Banking Committee.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/volcker-rule-regulatory-harmonization-act>

6. Amendment to the FAA Reauthorization Act of 2018 Striking Prevailing Wage Requirements

H. Amdt 557 to H.R. 4 · April 26, 2018

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 172 NAYs 243

This amendment by Rep. Steve King (R-Iowa) would repeal Davis-Bacon prevailing wage requirements for construction projects covered under this Act. Davis-Bacon has been a critical component of federally funded transportation projects for decades, and promotes a fair labor market by upholding local wage standards. The amendment failed on April 26, 2018.

Alert Letter Supporting FAA Reauthorization

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/amendment-faa-reauthorization-act-2018-striking-prevailing-wage>

7. FAA Reauthorization Act of 2018

H.R. 4 · April 27, 2018

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 393 NAYs 13

Properly funding, updating and improving standards for our federal aviation systems and workforce is critical to keeping our nation at the forefront of the global aviation sector. This bill will not only enhance our aviation system but also will improve safety for aviation workers and the flying public. The bill passed the House on April 27, 2018.

Alert Letter Supporting FAA Reauthorization

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/faa-reauthorization-act-2018>

8. Water Resources Development Act of 2018

H.R. 8 · June 6, 2018

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 408 NAYs 2

This bipartisan measure takes an important step towards modernizing and improving our nation's ports, harbors, inland waterways and flood risk management. The AFL-CIO commends the committee leadership for keeping to the two-year water infrastructure reauthorization schedule. Waterways are critical to keeping our domestic supply chain efficient and competitive. This bill would authorize Army Corps strategic investments in the nation's water navigation network, creating and sustaining thousands of good jobs, while simultaneously enhancing U.S. competitiveness in world markets. Passing this bill reduced the Army Corps project backlog, thereby ensuring that our nation continues to have an up-to-date maritime transportation system and is able to address other vital water infrastructure needs. The bill passed the House on June 6, 2018.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/water-resources-development-act-2018>

9. Securing America's Future Act of 2018

	H.R. 4760 · June 21, 2018
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 193 NAYs 231
	The FY 2019 Department of Labor, Health and Human Services, and Education (Labor HHS) Appropriations bill, reflects a misguided and dangerous approach to funding programs that serve millions of working Americans. Despite the increase of \$18 billion for non-defense discretionary programs in FY 2019, there is no increase in the Labor HHS allocation over FY 2018. The bill would reduce funding for the Department of Labor (DOL) by \$289 million, including a rescission of \$200 million from the Dislocated Worker training program. The bill cuts DOL's Wage and Hour Division by \$2 million, reduces the current funding for the National Labor Relations Board (NLRB) by almost \$13 million, and guts DOL's Bureau of International Labor Affairs (ILAB) by \$68 million (a reduction of 78.5 percent). ILAB does critical work to fight child labor, forced labor, and human trafficking and to enforce the labor rights commitments in our trade agreements. The proposed reduction in funding for ILAB would significantly undermine its capacity to help other countries improve their labor standards. The bill also targets worker safety programs, reducing funding for the Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) by \$7.5 million and funding for the Mine Safety and Health Administration by \$6 million. These cuts would occur at a time when the OSHA inspection staff is already at near record low levels and mining deaths are on the rise. The bill eliminates OSHA's Susan Harwood training grants, which have trained over a million workers in hazardous industries, while it increases funding for employer compliance assistance. These cuts to worker safety and health programs will result in increased disease, injuries, and deaths on the job. While the bill provides for a modest increase in funding for the Department of Health and Human Services, it would cut funding for Medicare and Medicaid operations and block implementation of the Affordable Care Act. The bill failed to pass the House on June 21, 2018.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/securing-america-future-act-2018

10. Agriculture and Nutrition Act of 2018

	H.R. 2 · June 21, 2018
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 213 NAYs 211
	The Agriculture Improvement Act of 2018 slashes critical funding for Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) and makes it more difficult for millions of Americans to feed themselves and their families. SNAP provides a vital lifeline to over 40 million households in the U.S. who regularly struggle to eat. This bill cuts \$17 billion in nutrition support, taking food assistance from 2 million people. It also resulted in 265,000 children losing access to free school meals. The bill passed the House on June 21, 2018, and was signed into law by President Trump on Dec. 20, 2018.
Alert	Letter Opposing Bill That Would Make It More Difficult for Americans to Feed Their Families
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/agriculture-and-nutrition-act-2018

11. Financial Services and General Government Appropriations, 2019

	H.R. 6147 · July 19, 2018
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 217 NAYs 199
	This bill represents a continued attack on financial regulation, underfunds agencies that are critical to the protection of workers and consumers, and includes several objectionable policy riders. Congress should not use spending bills as back-door vehicles for reversing vital protections against Wall Street abuse. Attaching highly controversial and partisan poison pill policy riders that roll back financial regulations to an appropriations bill is an abuse of the appropriations process. The bill passed the House on July 19, 2018.
Alert	Letter Opposing Bill That Would Undermine Financial Market Regulation
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/financial-services-and-general-government-appropriations-2019

12. Increasing Access to Lower Premium Plans and Expanding Health Savings Accounts Act of 2018

	H.R. 6311 · July 25, 2018
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 242 NAYs 176
	This misnamed legislation would allow insurers to offer junk "copper" plans to workers purchasing insurance on the individual market, encourages the expanded use catastrophic health plans, and nearly doubles the contribution limits allowed for health savings accounts (a tax break that favors wealthy households). The bill passed the House on July 25, 2018.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/increasing-access-lower-premium-plans-and-expanding-health-savings

13. Restoring Access to Medication and Modernizing Health Savings Accounts Act of 2018

H.R. 6199 · July 25, 2018
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 277 NAYs 142
This bill inappropriately allows funds from health savings accounts to be used for boutique medical care and fitness programs, a tax break that would favor wealthier households and seldom be used by people of moderate income. The bill passed the House on July 25, 2018.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/restoring-access-medication-and-modernizing-health-savings-accounts-act>

14. Protecting Family and Small Business Tax Cuts Act of 2018

H.R. 6760 · September 28, 2018
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 220 NAYs 191
To justify a second round of tax cuts, this misnamed bill is doubling down on the discredited economic theory that another \$657 billion in tax breaks for the wealthy and corporations will strengthen our economy and provide “trickle-down” benefits to working families. This \$2 trillion tax giveaway has done little to strengthen the economy and, more importantly, working families have not come close to getting the \$4,000 salary raise promised by the bill’s proponents. Instead, we have seen worsening economic inequality and some \$710 billion in corporate stock buybacks—a phenomenon of little, if any benefit, to middle class Americans. There is no justification whatsoever for this tax cut, yet it passed the House on Sept. 28, 2018.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/protecting-family-and-small-business-tax-cuts-act-2018>

15. Motion to Concur on a Bill That Gives More Tax Cuts for the Wealthy and Corporations

H.R. 88 · December 20, 2018
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 220 NAYs 183
This motion to concur on a bill that gives more tax cuts for the wealthy and corporations—The Retirement, Savings and Other Tax Relief Act (H.R. 88)—is an excuse to cut critical priorities for working people such as Social Security, Medicare, Medicaid, infrastructure, and education in the future. The Congressional Budget Office and the Joint Committee on Taxation estimate that H.R. 88 would cost \$54.7 billion over 10 years. In addition, H.R. 88 includes handouts and favors to narrowly tailored and wealthy special interests. The motion to concur passed the House on Dec. 20, 2018.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/house/motion-concur-bill-gives-more-tax-cuts-wealthy-and-corporations>

SENATE

1. Cloture Vote: Amendment to the Broader Options for Americans Act

S. Amdt. 1948 to S. Amdt. 2579 · February 15, 2018
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 54 NAYs 45
This amendment by Sen. Pat Toomey (R-Pa.) to S. Amdt. 1959 to the Broader Options for Americans Act (H.R. 2579) would have placed unnecessary burdens on law enforcement agents and establish draconian law enforcement scenarios for aspiring immigrants. Cloture on the amendment failed on Feb. 15, 2018.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/senate/cloture-vote-amendment-broader-options-americans-act>

2. Economic Growth, Regulatory Relief and Consumer Protection Act

S. 2155 · March 14, 2018
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 67 NAYs 31
This misnamed bill puts consumers and our economy at greater risk by weakening important financial regulations put in place after the 2008 crisis to protect Americans from predatory lending and promote financial stability. It undermines the current safety and soundness requirements that apply to mid-size banks and gives even the largest Wall Street megabanks new statutory tools for pressuring the Federal Reserve to weaken regulations designed to make banks more accountable. It weakens protections against predatory, unaffordable mortgage lending practices and broadens exemptions from the mortgage affordability requirements created by Dodd-Frank. The bill passed the Senate on March 14, 2018, and became law on May 24, 2018.
Alert Letter Opposing Legislation That Would Put Consumers At Risk
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/senate/economic-growth-regulatory-relief-and-consumer-protection-act>

3. Confirmation of John F. Ring to the National Labor Relations Board

	April 11, 2018
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 50 NAYs 48
	President Donald Trump nominated yet another management lawyer with no experience representing working people to the National Labor Relations Board (NLRB). John F. Ring has an extensive track record at the corporate law firm Morgan, Lewis & Bockius representing employers before the NLRB, other agencies and in the courts, but to our knowledge, he has no experience representing working people seeking to exercise their rights. Ring was confirmed on April 11, 2018, and became the third Republican member of the five member NLRB.
Alert	Letter Concerning the Nomination of John Ring to the NLRB
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/senate/confirmation-john-f-ring-national-labor-relations-board

4. Cloture Vote: Amendment to the Tribal Labor Sovereignty Act

	April 16, 2018
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 55 NAYs 41
	An amendment to the Tribal Labor Sovereignty Act, which would deny protection under the National Labor Relations Act (NLRA) to a large number of workers employed by tribal-owned and -operated enterprises located on tribal land. Among these workers are over 600,000 tribal casino workers, the vast majority of whom are not Native Americans. In recent years, the number and type of enterprises affected has grown well beyond the gaming industry, and would now include mining operations, power plants, smoke shops, saw mills, construction companies, ski resorts, high-tech firms, hotels, and spas. Many of these are commercial businesses that compete with non-Indian enterprises. As proposed, the Tribal Labor Sovereignty Act would strip all workers in these enterprises of their rights and protections under the NLRA. The motion to invoke cloture failed on April 16, 2018.
Alert	Letter Opposing a Bill That Would Deprive Workers Employed by Tribal-Owned and -Operated Enterprises Their Rights and Protections Under the NLRA
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/senate/cloture-vote-amendment-tribal-labor-sovereignty-act

5. Confirmation of Brett M. Kavanaugh to the United States Supreme Court

	October 6, 2018
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 50 NAYs 48
	Any Supreme Court nominee must be fair, independent and committed to protecting the rights, freedoms and legal safeguards of all Americans. Judge Brett Kavanaugh has a dangerous track record of protecting the privileges of the wealthy and powerful at the expense of working people. Judge Kavanaugh was confirmed on October 6, 2018.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2018/senate/confirmation-brett-m-kavanaugh-united-states-supreme-court